

CMT 442 – Neural Networks

Module 5: Model Evaluation and Explainable AI

Duration: 1 Hour

Standards Alignment: ISO/IEC 42001 (Performance Evaluation), NIST AI RMF – Measure

CMT 442 – Neural Networks

Module 5: Model Evaluation & Explainable AI

Evaluation Metrics



Accuracy



Precision & Recall



Confusion Matrix



MSE / RMSE

Overfitting & Underfitting



High Variance



Feature Importance
Saliency Maps

Explainable AI (XAI)



LIME & SHAP



Feature Importance
Saliency Maps



High Variance



High Bias

Key Takeaway:

*“Accuracy measures performance;
Explainability measures trust.”*

ISO/IEC 42001

NIST AI RMF

Lecture Objectives

By the end of this lecture, students should be able to:

- Evaluate neural network performance using appropriate metrics
 - Identify and mitigate overfitting and underfitting
 - Explain AI model decisions using XAI techniques
 - Link explainability to AI governance and accountability
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Lecture Breakdown

0 – 10 min | Why Model Evaluation Matters

Key Concepts

- Difference between *training success* and *real-world performance*
- Why “high accuracy” can still mean **high risk**
- AI failures due to poor evaluation (bias, drift, opacity)

Instructor Emphasis

“If you cannot explain a model, you cannot govern it.”

Prompt

- Why would a regulator reject a highly accurate AI model?
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10 – 25 min | Evaluation Metrics in Neural Networks

Classification Metrics

- Accuracy (and its limitations)
- Precision, Recall, F1-Score
- Confusion Matrix

Regression Metrics

- Mean Squared Error (MSE)
- Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE)
- R^2 Score

Advanced Concepts

- ROC curves & AUC
- Cost-sensitive evaluation

Example

- Medical diagnosis NN: false negatives vs false positives
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25 – 35 min | Overfitting, Underfitting & Generalization

Core Concepts

- Bias–variance trade-off
- Training vs validation vs test sets
- Data leakage risks

Mitigation Techniques

- Regularization (L1, L2)
- Dropout
- Early stopping
- Cross-validation

Mini Exercise

- Identify overfitting symptoms from learning curves
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35 – 50 min | Explainable AI (XAI)

Why Explainability Matters

- Trust
- Accountability
- Legal and ethical compliance
- ISO/IEC 42001 performance transparency

XAI Techniques

- Model-agnostic:
 - LIME
 - SHAP
- Model-specific:
 - Feature importance
 - Saliency maps (CNNs)

Case Study

- Loan approval neural network: explain rejection reasons
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50 – 60 min | Governance, Risk & Wrap-Up

Governance Link

- Explainability as an audit requirement
- Evidence for AI oversight committees
- Continuous performance monitoring

Discussion

- Should black-box AI be allowed in critical systems?

Key Takeaway

“Evaluation measures accuracy; explainability measures trust.”

Module 5: Model Evaluation & Explainable AI

(10 CAT-style Scenario Questions)

1. A neural network used for loan approvals shows **96% accuracy**, but customer complaints are rising.
 - a) Identify two evaluation metrics you would review beyond accuracy.
 - b) Explain what risk the bank is currently exposed to.
2. During training, your model performs extremely well on training data but poorly on validation data.
 - a) Name the issue.
 - b) Propose two mitigation techniques and justify them.
3. A healthcare AI model misclassifies rare diseases.
 - a) Which metric best captures this risk?
 - b) Why would accuracy be misleading in this case?
4. Regulators request an explanation of why a patient was flagged as “high risk” by a neural network.
 - a) Identify one suitable XAI technique.
 - b) Explain how it improves accountability.
5. Two models have identical accuracy, but one has higher variance.
 - a) Which model would you deploy in production?
 - b) Defend your choice from a governance perspective.
6. A CNN shows unstable performance after deployment due to new data patterns.
 - a) What evaluation weakness does this indicate?
 - b) How would you address it?
7. A financial institution refuses to deploy a black-box model despite superior performance.

Explain this decision using ISO/IEC 42001 principles.

8. A data scientist removes explainability tools to improve performance speed.
 - a) Identify the governance risk.
 - b) Recommend a balanced solution.
9. A confusion matrix shows high false negatives in fraud detection.
Explain the business impact and corrective action.
10. Explain why **explainability is a performance requirement**, not just an ethical preference.